

Four

Bachtatonic/Rocktatonic

Inventions

*for Oboe, Clarinet in B flat
and Piano*

by
Christopher Kies

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Program Note

for

Four Bachtatonic/Rocktatonc Inventions for Oboe, Clarinet in B flat and Piano

In the Fall of 2018, I embarked on a project that grew out of my long-term fascination with the inherent capabilities of the octatonic scale to represent quasi-tonal effects in music. All I needed was a bad pun to get started, and that was the title: Bachtatonic etc.. As a pianist, I am very fond of J.S. Bach's great two- and three-part inventions. My first thought was to re-write some of those inventions using the three transpositions of the octatonic scale in which each of the Tonic, Dominant and Subdominant functions would be expressed through its own respective octatonic scale. Other, more remote, tonal roots could also be represented by one of the three octatonic transpositions since each scale contains four potentially "quasi-tonal" root tones. Once I had completed the re-writing of four of the two-part inventions in this manner, I realized that something was missing, and that was the element of surprise! For this, I borrowed on my similarly long-term admiration for the music of a certain British rock group from the 1960's. The second half of each of my inventions superimposes a famous tune by this rock group on top of the Bach piece. I had to make some adjustments to make these diverse pieces work together, but, in the end, it was surprisingly easy to do, thanks to the universally adaptable octatonic scales. To date, I have arranged these same four pieces for clarinet, marimba and piano, for two pianos, and for oboe, clarinet and piano. I hope that everyone will recognize some of their favorite classic rock tunes in this music.

---CK. 11.2020

Bachtatonic/Rocktatonc Invention No. 1

for oboe, clarinet, and piano

Score in C

by Christopher Kies
September 2018

The musical score is written for three instruments: Oboe, Clarinet in B flat, and Piano. The time signature is 3/8. The tempo is marked with a quarter note equal to 56 (♩. = 56). The dynamics include *mp* (mezzo-piano).

The score is divided into two systems. The first system shows the Oboe and Clarinet staves, and the Piano staff. The Oboe part begins with a melodic line, while the Clarinet and Piano parts are mostly rests. The Piano part enters in the third measure with a bass line.

The second system continues the music. The Clarinet part enters in the first measure of this system with a melodic line. The Piano part continues its bass line. The Oboe part has rests in the first two measures of this system.

Rehearsal marks are indicated by a box with the number 5 at the beginning of the first measure of the second system for both the Clarinet and Piano parts.

Bachtatonic/Rocktatonc Invention No. 2

for oboe, clarinet, and piano

Score in C

by Christopher Kies
September 2018

The musical score is written for three instruments: Oboe, Clarinet in B flat, and Piano. The tempo is marked as 104 beats per minute, indicated by a quarter note followed by "= 104". The time signature is 3/8. The score is divided into two systems. The first system shows the Oboe and Clarinet staves, with the Piano part below them. The Oboe part begins with a melodic line, while the Clarinet and Piano parts are mostly rests. The second system shows the continuation of the pieces. The Oboe part has a measure marked with a box containing the number 5. The Clarinet part has a measure marked with a box containing the number 5. The Piano part has a measure marked with a box containing the number 5. The score includes various musical notations such as notes, rests, and dynamic markings like *mp* (mezzo-piano) and *p* (piano).

Bachtatonic/Rocktatonc Invention No. 3

for oboe, clarinet, and piano

by Christopher Kies
September 2018

Score in C

Oboe

Clarinet in B flat

Piano

$\bullet = 96$

mp

p

4

4

Bachtatonic/Rocktatonc Invention No. 4

Score in C

for oboe, clarinet, and piano

by Christopher Kies
September 2018

The musical score is written for three instruments: Oboe, Clarinet in B flat, and Piano. The tempo is marked as 112 beats per minute. The score is in 3/4 time and consists of three systems of music.

System 1: The Oboe part begins with a melody in the right hand, marked *mf*. The Clarinet in B flat part enters in the second measure with a melody in the right hand, also marked *mf*. The Piano part is silent in this system.

System 2: The Oboe part continues its melody. The Clarinet in B flat part continues its melody. The Piano part enters in the first measure with a melody in the right hand, marked *mf*. The Piano part continues with a complex, fast-moving melody in both hands.

System 3: The Oboe part continues its melody. The Clarinet in B flat part continues its melody. The Piano part continues its complex, fast-moving melody in both hands.